More Ships Attacked Near an Important Oil Waterway

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The **Strait** of Hormuz is a narrow waterway in the Middle East. Many ships carry oil through it to the rest of the world. Since the war between the US and Israel and Iran began, ships there have been attacked.

Between October 5 and October 11, twelve ships were reported attacked. That is the most in one week since the war started. These numbers are **approximate**.

Experts say Iran is attacking ships to try to control the waterway. The US military is helping more **tankers** travel through safely. It says ships are still moving through the **strait**. When one container ship sank this week, all 21 crew members were safely **evacuated**.

The attacks have slowed oil shipments. About 12.6 million **barrels** a day passed through on October 13, according to the data firm Kpler. Before the war, it was about 17 million.

Word Treasure

strait -- A narrow strip of water that connects two bigger seas.
tankers -- Big ships that carry liquids like oil.
approximate -- Close to the right number, but not exact.
evacuated -- Moved safely away from danger.
barrels -- A way to measure how much oil there is.

Background you need

The Strait of Hormuz is a narrow waterway between Iran and countries on the Arabian Peninsula.

Many countries send oil by ship through this waterway to the rest of the world.

When fewer ships can pass safely, less oil reaches other countries.

Break it down

WHO: Ships, Iran and the US military
WHAT: More ships were attacked in one week than any week since the war began
WHERE: The Strait of Hormuz in the Middle East
WHY: Experts say Iran wants more control over the waterway

Why it matters

Oil from this waterway is used to make fuel, so problems there can affect gas prices around the world.

Test what you remember

1. What is the Strait of Hormuz?

(A) An island
(B) A mountain
(C) A city
(D) A narrow waterway

2. How many ships were reported attacked from October 5 to October 11?

(A) Twelve
(B) Two
(C) Seven
(D) Twenty

3. Who do experts say is attacking the ships?

(A) Canada
(B) Iran
(C) Kpler
(D) Oman

4. What happened to the crew of the ship that sank?

(A) They stayed on the ship
(B) They were safely evacuated
(C) They swam to shore
(D) No one knows

5. About how many barrels a day passed through on October 13?

(A) 1 million
(B) 12.6 million
(C) 50 million
(D) 17 million

6. Who is helping tankers travel through safely?

(A) The US military
(B) A data firm
(C) Fishermen
(D) A school

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: D 2: A 3: B 4: B 5: B 6: A

Questions to think about

1. **Experts: Say Iran is attacking ships to try to control the waterway.**
2. **US military: Says ships are still moving through the strait.**

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):